



BUSINESSVANCE

BUSINESS PLAN QUESTIONNAIRE

CLIENT QUESTIONNAIRE

Please complete this questionnaire as thoroughly and accurately as possible. The information provided will be used to prepare a professional business plan covering your concept, market, operations, marketing, management, finances, risks and growth strategy.

1. Client Information

CLIENT DETAIL	INFORMATION
Full name	
Business name	
Email address	
Contact number	
City / Province / Country	
Preferred report language: ☐ English ☐ Afrikaans	

2. Purpose of the Business Plan

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Start a new business | ☐ Apply for bank funding |
| ☐ Apply for government funding | ☐ Attract an investor |
| ☐ Approach a business partner | ☐ Expand an existing business |
| ☐ Purchase equipment or assets | ☐ Apply for a lease |
| ☐ Guide operations | ☐ Introduce a new product or service |
| ☐ Purchase an existing business | ☐ Other |
| ☐ Business owner | ☐ Bank or lender |
| ☐ Investor | ☐ Funding organisation |
| ☐ Government department | ☐ Business partner |
| ☐ Landlord | ☐ Management team |
| ☐ Other | |

2.1 What are the main questions the business plan should answer?

2.2 Is there a funding, application or presentation deadline?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ One-year plan | ☐ Three-year plan |
| ☐ Five-year plan | ☐ Other |

3. Business Overview

3.1 Briefly describe the business or business idea.

3.2 What products or services will the business offer?

3.3 What problem does the business solve?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Idea stage | ☐ Research stage |
| ☐ Planning stage | ☐ Pre-launch |
| ☐ Recently launched | ☐ Operating under 1 year |
| ☐ Operating 1-3 years | ☐ Operating over 3 years |
| ☐ Expanding | ☐ Purchasing an existing business |

3.4 Start date or planned launch date:

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Product-based | ☐ Service-based | ☐ Subscription-based |
| ☐ Contract-based | ☐ Commission-based | ☐ Rental-based |
| ☐ Manufacturing | ☐ Retail | ☐ Wholesale |
| ☐ Online | ☐ Physical | ☐ Mobile |
| ☐ Combination | | |

4. Business Name and Legal Structure

4.1 Proposed or registered business name:

4.2 Registration number, if applicable:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Name approved/registered | ☐ Application in progress |
| ☐ Not yet registered | |
| ☐ Sole proprietor | ☐ Private company |
| ☐ Partnership | ☐ Cooperative |
| ☐ Non-profit organisation | ☐ Franchise |
| ☐ Other | ☐ Not yet decided |

4.3 Why was this structure selected?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Tax registered | ☐ Tax registration planned |
| ☐ VAT registered | ☐ VAT registration planned |
| ☐ Not registered | ☐ Unsure |

4.4 Licences, permits or professional registrations required:

5. Ownership and Shareholding

NAME	POSITION	OWNERSHIP %	CONTRIBUTION

☐ Shareholders/partnership agreement in place

☐ No agreement

☐ Not applicable

☐ Investors may receive ownership

5.1 Who will make final business decisions?

6. Vision, Mission and Objectives

6.1 Long-term vision:

6.2 Mission or main purpose:

☐ Launch business

☐ Reach break-even

☐ Gain target number of customers

☐ Achieve sales target

☐ Employ staff

☐ Secure contracts

☐ Build brand awareness

☐ Expand product range

☐ Open premises

☐ Other

6.3 Main 12-month objectives:

6.4 Three-year goals:

6.5 What would success look like after five years?

7. Products and Services

PRODUCT / SERVICE	DESCRIPTION	SELLING PRICE	EST. COST

7.1 Main product or service focus:

7.2 Most profitable product or service:

7.3 New products or services planned:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Manufacture internally | ☐ Purchase from suppliers |
| ☐ Import | ☐ Third-party manufacture |
| ☐ Resell finished products | ☐ Not applicable |
| ☐ Once-off purchase | ☐ Weekly repeat |
| ☐ Monthly repeat | ☐ Occasional repeat |
| ☐ Subscription | ☐ Contract basis |
| ☐ Seasonal | |

8. Unique Value Proposition

8.1 Why should customers choose your business?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Lower prices | ☐ Better quality |
| ☐ Faster service | ☐ Better customer service |
| ☐ Specialist expertise | ☐ Unique offering |
| ☐ Greater convenience | ☐ Better location |
| ☐ Customisation | ☐ More experience |
| ☐ Better guarantees | ☐ Other |

8.2 Strongest customer benefit:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Qualifications | ☐ Industry experience |
| ☐ Testimonials | ☐ Reviews |
| ☐ Case studies | ☐ Product testing |
| ☐ Guarantees | ☐ Awards |

☐ Existing sales☐ Other

9. Industry Overview and Market Opportunity

9.1 Industry:

☐ Growing☐ Stable☐ Declining☐ Highly competitive☐ New/emerging☐ Seasonal☐ Unsure

9.2 Industry trends, technology changes and regulations:

9.3 Why is there an opportunity for this business?

☐ Existing sales☐ Customer enquiries☐ Pre-orders☐ Waiting list☐ Customer surveys☐ Social-media interest☐ Competitor activity☐ Industry research☐ Previous experience☐ Signed contracts☐ No evidence yet☐ Other

9.4 Number of interested or committed customers:

☐ Consistent demand☐ Seasonal demand☐ Event-based☐ Contract-based☐ Uncertain

10. Target Market and Buying Behaviour

10.1 Describe the ideal customer:

☐ Individuals☐ Families☐ Parents☐ Children/teenagers☐ Students☐ Professionals☐ Small businesses☐ Large businesses☐ Government☐ Schools/institutions☐ Non-profit organisations☐ Other☐ Under 18☐ 18-24☐ 25-34☐ 35-44☐ 45-54☐ 55-64☐ 65+☐ Not age-specific

10.2 Typical income, budget or business size:

10.3 Geographic areas to target:

10.4 Customer problem or need:

- ☐ Price
- ☐ Convenience
- ☐ Reliability
- ☐ Expertise
- ☐ Flexibility
- ☐ Google
- ☐ Instagram
- ☐ LinkedIn
- ☐ Referrals
- ☐ Sales representatives
- ☐ Other
- ☐ User
- ☐ Business owner
- ☐ Procurement department
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Immediate decision
- ☐ A few days
- ☐ One month or longer
- ☐ Quality
- ☐ Speed
- ☐ Customer service
- ☐ Reputation
- ☐ Results
- ☐ Facebook
- ☐ TikTok
- ☐ WhatsApp
- ☐ Physical stores
- ☐ Online marketplaces
- ☐ Parent/guardian
- ☐ Manager
- ☐ School/institution
- ☐ Same day
- ☐ A few weeks
- ☐ Unsure

10.5 Main objections that may prevent purchase:

11. Competitor Analysis

COMPETITOR	LOCATION	MAIN OFFERING	PRICE RANGE

11.1 Strongest competitor and why:

11.2 What competitors do well:

11.3 Gaps or weaknesses:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Compete on lower price | ☐ Better value |
| ☐ Better quality | ☐ Faster service |
| ☐ Specialist offering | ☐ Better customer service |
| ☐ Convenience | ☐ Location |
| ☐ Branding | ☐ Other |

11.4 Indirect competitors or substitutes:

12. Pricing and Revenue Model

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Competitor pricing | ☐ Cost plus margin |
| ☐ Customer research | ☐ Industry standard |
| ☐ Supplier recommendation | ☐ Personal estimate |
| ☐ Existing prices | ☐ Not yet decided |
| ☐ Budget option | ☐ Affordable value |
| ☐ Similar to competitors | ☐ Premium |
| ☐ Specialist high-value | |

12.1 Discounts, payment plans or credit offered:

12.2 Expected average sale per customer:

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| ☐ Product sales | ☐ Service fees | ☐ Consultation fees |
| ☐ Subscriptions | ☐ Membership fees | ☐ Contracts |
| ☐ Commission | ☐ Rental income | ☐ Delivery fees |
| ☐ Installation fees | ☐ Training fees | ☐ Maintenance fees |
| ☐ Licensing | ☐ Advertising | ☐ Other |

REVENUE STREAM	PRICE / FEE	MONTHLY QUANTITY	MONTHLY INCOME

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Recurring income | ☐ Partly recurring |
| ☐ Once-off income | ☐ Depends on one major customer/contract |

13. Marketing and Sales Strategy

- | | | |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ☐ Facebook | ☐ Instagram | ☐ TikTok |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|

- | | | |
|--|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ LinkedIn | ☐ YouTube | ☐ Google |
| ☐ Website | ☐ Email | ☐ WhatsApp |
| ☐ Flyers | ☐ Radio | ☐ Newspapers |
| ☐ Events/markets | ☐ Referrals | ☐ Partnerships |
| ☐ Sales representatives | ☐ Other | |

13.1 Best expected marketing channel:

13.2 Monthly marketing budget:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Paid advertising planned | ☐ No paid advertising |
| ☐ Possibly | |
| ☐ Product ads | ☐ Educational content |
| ☐ Videos | ☐ Testimonials |
| ☐ Customer success stories | ☐ Promotions |
| ☐ Before-and-after results | ☐ Other |

13.3 Launch promotion or introductory offer:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Physical premises | ☐ Website |
| ☐ Online store | ☐ WhatsApp |
| ☐ Social media | ☐ Sales representative |
| ☐ Telephone | ☐ Customer premises |
| ☐ Retail partners | ☐ Other |

13.4 Describe the sales process from enquiry to payment:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Owner handles sales | ☐ Employee |
| ☐ Sales representative | ☐ External agent |
| ☐ Automated system | |
| ☐ Cash | ☐ EFT |
| ☐ Card | ☐ Online payment |
| ☐ Debit order | ☐ Credit |
| ☐ Other | |

14. Customer Service and Retention**14.1 Customer service approach:**

14.2 Guarantees, warranties or refund policies:

14.3 Complaint handling process:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Follow-up messages | ☐ Email marketing |
| ☐ WhatsApp communication | ☐ Loyalty programme |
| ☐ Subscriptions | ☐ Discounts |
| ☐ Referral rewards | ☐ Excellent service |
| ☐ Other | |
| ☐ Customer database maintained | ☐ No customer database |

15. Location, Premises and Operations

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Home-based | ☐ Rented shop |
| ☐ Office | ☐ Workshop |
| ☐ Factory | ☐ Warehouse |
| ☐ Shared workspace | ☐ Mobile unit |
| ☐ Customer premises | ☐ Online only |
| ☐ Other | |
| ☐ Location secured | ☐ Still looking |
| ☐ Not required | |

15.1 Why is this location suitable?

15.2 Monthly rent and deposit:

15.3 Renovations required and estimated cost:

15.4 Describe daily operations:

15.5 Operating hours:

15.6 Main steps in delivering the offering:

15.7 Expected capacity per day/week/month:

15.8 Activities completed internally:

15.9 Activities outsourced:

☐ Operating procedures available

☐ Partly available

☐ Not available
16. Equipment, Technology, Suppliers and Stock

EQUIPMENT / ASSET	QUANTITY	COST EACH	TOTAL

16.1 Assets already owned:

16.2 Equipment to be leased or financed:

16.3 Vehicle requirement:

☐ Computer/laptop

☐ Mobile phone

☐ Printer

☐ Internet

☐ Point-of-sale

☐ Card machine

☐ Accounting software

☐ Booking system

☐ Customer database

☐ Website

☐ Online store

☐ Cloud storage

☐ Other

TECHNOLOGY / SYSTEM	ONCE-OFF COST	MONTHLY COST

SUPPLIER	PRODUCT / SERVICE	LOCATION	PAYMENT TERMS

☐ Depends on one supplier

☐ Backup suppliers available

☐ Stock required

☐ Products/materials imported

16.4 Opening stock cost and purchase frequency:

17. Management, Staffing and Organisation

17.1 Who will manage the business?

17.2 Owner/management experience and qualifications:

POSITION	NUMBER	MONTHLY SALARY	START DATE

17.3 Staff training required:

17.4 Missing skills:

☐ Business can operate without owner

☐ Partly

☐ No

ROLE	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	MAIN RESPONSIBILITIES

ROLE	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	MAIN RESPONSIBILITIES

BUSINESS FUNCTION	RESPONSIBLE PERSON

- ☐ Accountant
- ☐ Tax practitioner
- ☐ Business consultant
- ☐ IT support
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Bookkeeper
- ☐ Attorney
- ☐ Marketing specialist
- ☐ Health and safety consultant

18. Startup Costs and Monthly Expenses

STARTUP COST	ESTIMATED AMOUNT

STARTUP COST	ESTIMATED AMOUNT

18.1 Estimated total startup cost:

18.2 Startup costs already paid:

MONTHLY EXPENSE	ESTIMATED AMOUNT

18.3 Estimated total monthly expenses:

19. Sales Forecast and Funding

19.1 Average customers/orders per month:

19.2 Average sale per customer:

19.3 Expected monthly and annual revenue:

MONTH	EXPECTED SALES

19.4 Assumptions supporting the forecast:

19.5 Owner funds available:

19.6 External funding required:

- ☐ Bank loan
- ☐ Government funding
- ☐ Vehicle finance
- ☐ Family/friends
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Investor funding
- ☐ Asset finance
- ☐ Partner contribution
- ☐ Personal loan

USE OF FUNDING	AMOUNT

USE OF FUNDING	AMOUNT

- ☐ Funding approved
 ☐ Application in progress
- ☐ Not yet applied

19.7 Owner contribution:

20. Loan and Financial Targets

20.1 Requested loan amount:

20.2 Preferred repayment period:

20.3 Interest rate if known:

20.4 Maximum affordable monthly repayment:

20.5 Collateral/security available:

FINANCIAL TARGET	TARGET

20.6 Monthly profit required to make the business worthwhile:

- ☐ Profit needed under 1 month
 ☐ 1-3 months
- ☐ 4-6 months
 ☐ 7-12 months
- ☐ More than 12 months

21. Risks and SWOT Analysis

RISK	POSSIBLE IMPACT	PLANNED RESPONSE

- ☐ Low sales
- ☐ Cash-flow shortages
- ☐ Supplier problems
- ☐ Equipment failure
- ☐ Technology failure
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Strong competition
- ☐ High operating costs
- ☐ Staff shortages
- ☐ Legal/compliance problems
- ☐ Economic conditions

21.1 What could cause the business to fail?

21.2 What action will be taken if sales are lower than expected?

21.3 Strengths:

21.4 Weaknesses:

21.5 Opportunities:

21.6 Threats:

22. Growth Strategy and Implementation

- ☐ More customers
- ☐ New branches
- ☐ Online growth
- ☐ Franchising
- ☐ Additional offerings
- ☐ New geographic areas
- ☐ Staff expansion
- ☐ Licensing

- ☐ Partnerships
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Exporting

22.1 When is expansion expected to begin?

22.2 Resources required for growth:

- ☐ Can be franchised/licensed
- ☐ No
- ☐ Possibly
- ☐ Possibly
- ☐ Can operate without owner
- ☐ No

ACTION	PERSON RESPONSIBLE	TARGET DATE	STATUS

23. Business Plan Requirements

- ☐ Executive summary
- ☐ Vision, mission and objectives
- ☐ Products and services
- ☐ Market analysis
- ☐ Competitor analysis
- ☐ Marketing strategy
- ☐ Operations plan
- ☐ Organisational structure
- ☐ Sales forecast
- ☐ Cash-flow forecast
- ☐ Funding requirement
- ☐ Risk assessment
- ☐ Implementation timeline
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Business description
- ☐ Ownership and legal structure
- ☐ Industry analysis
- ☐ Target customer profile
- ☐ SWOT analysis
- ☐ Sales strategy
- ☐ Management and staffing
- ☐ Startup cost estimate
- ☐ Profit-and-loss forecast
- ☐ Break-even analysis
- ☐ Loan repayment information
- ☐ Growth strategy
- ☐ Supporting appendices

24. Supporting Documents and Additional Comments

- ☐ Company registration
- ☐ Tax documents
- ☐ Owner/management CVs
- ☐ Owner ID documents
- ☐ Licences/permits
- ☐ Qualifications

- ☐ Product photos
- ☐ Price list
- ☐ Equipment quotations
- ☐ Vehicle quotations
- ☐ Bank statements
- ☐ Customer contracts
- ☐ Market research
- ☐ Logo/branding files
- ☐ Funding documents
- ☐ Product catalogue
- ☐ Supplier quotations
- ☐ Rental quotation/lease
- ☐ Financial statements
- ☐ Sales records
- ☐ Letters of intent
- ☐ Competitor information
- ☐ Existing business plan
- ☐ Other

24.1 Relevant links or additional information:

24.2 Additional comments:

Client Declaration

I confirm that the information supplied in this questionnaire is accurate to the best of my knowledge. I understand that the business plan will be based on the information provided, available supporting documents, market research and reasonable business assumptions. I understand that a business plan is a planning and decision-support document and does not guarantee funding approval, investment, customer demand, revenue, profitability or business success.

DECLARATION DETAIL	INFORMATION
Client name	
Signature	
Date	

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ADMINISTRATION DETAIL	INFORMATION
Client reference	
Report package	
Payment received: ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Business stage	
Business industry	
Business location	

Purpose of business plan	
Funding amount requested	
Forecast period	
Supporting documents received: ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partial	
Report due date	
Additional information required	